the rebuke – a quotation by a thirteenth-century poet, Shaikh Nizami: ‘Sit not idle, ‘tis not the time for play / ‘Tis the time for arts and for work.’

. Iqtidar Alam Khan, *The Political Biography of a Mughal Noble* (Orient Longman, 1973). The story was told by Bayazid.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Vincent Smith writes that Akbar was originally named Badruddin (‘the full moon of religion’) because he was born on a full-moon night, 23 November, not 15 October as officially stated. The change of date would ‘[frustrate] the calculations of hostile astrologers’. See Vincent A. Smith, *Akbar the Great Mogul, 1542–1605* (Clarendon Press, 1917).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. The Gakkhars ruled over parts of what is now the province of Punjab in Pakistan.

. Abul Fazl’s aspersions may well have something to do with the fact that Sultan Adam lost both favour and his kingdom under Akbar’s rule. Jouher remembers it differently. According to him, the sultan came to pay homage, if rather late, but excused himself with the fact that he had a guest whom he could hardly leave unsupervised. ‘You have done right,’ Humayun replied, ‘that was of more consequence.’

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*.

. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun*.

. When Ghulam Ali, a paymaster, tried to pull rank on Ali Dost, the latter replied that Ghulam Ali wouldn’t give out a single coin without Humayun’s explicit leave, so why should Ali Dost carry out such an irreversible act ‘without a personal order from his Majesty? Perhaps tomorrow the King may say, “Why did you put out the eyes of my brother?” What answer could I give? Depend upon it,’ he concluded, ‘I will not do it by *your* order.’ See Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*.

. Humayun noticed his water bearer’s unhappy mood and sent a man to ask why Jouher had returned to his tent (from Kamran’s) without orders. Had he left his task unfinished? Jouher replied (waspishly?), ‘[T]he business I had been sent on was *quite completed*.’ Humayun seems to have understood what his servant was feeling, perhaps he was a little abashed. He sent word back: There was no need for Jouher to return to Kamran’s tent; let him, instead, ‘get the water ready for me to bathe’. Ibid.

. S. Roy, ‘Humayun’, in *The Mughul Empire*, ed. R.C. Majumdar (Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, 1974).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 1.

. Sometimes Islam Shah.

. Abul Fazl is quite clear on these two counts: that Humayun left on his conquest after he heard of Salim Shah’s death, and that he marched out of Kabul in mid-November 1554. It is generally accepted that Salim Shah died on 22 November 1554.

. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 1. Muazzam’s treachery was discovered after the battle and he was arrested.

. S. Roy, ‘Humayun’.

. The lines are by a fifteenth-century poet called Shaikh Azari.

. This much-quoted witticism appears in Stanley Lane-Poole’s *Mediaeval India Under Mohammedan Rule, 712–1764* (T. Fisher Unwin, 1903).